

Application Cartography

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Golden Idea

Here's how to optimally find software engineering jobs and internships to apply for, based on where you're currently at in your journey — and the frequency by which you're going to apply.

Importance

What's the main reason this idea is important to understand?

- Your approach changes based on the level of roles you're going for — so this video is where I'll teach you the tactics of how to apply optimally.

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What are the key points of this video, the main things your audience should understand about it?

AM

Application for Employment

Accommodations for persons with disabilities in the hiring process. If your disability is not disclosed, we will provide assistance. If your disability is not disclosed, we will provide assistance.

	Date of Application	Date Available
	Middle Initial	

What is a Job Application?

The goal of the application is to simply get the first round of the interview process — whether that’s an online assessment or interview. That’s pretty much it.

More specifically, we’re defining an application as the “act of submitting a form online with your candidate information expressing interest in the role” through 1) the company’s website/application portal or 2) a third-party — LinkedIn, Indeed, ZipRecruiter, etc.

Ex. Google application, LinkedIn application, etc.

Most people see “Getting The Interview = Submitting An Application”. This could not be more wrong. Submitting an application is **necessary but not sufficient**.

Ex. Cold applying is like planting a seed in the dirt and expecting to come back and see it be a massive tree, without any additional effort or work. It’s asinine (extremely stupid or foolish).



🔥 Cold vs Warm Application

A cold application is applying without any other backup or work whatsoever, and it's what is stopping most of you from getting that first interview.

A warm application is applying but with at least one element of backup (referral, recruiter email, etc.) — which we'll discuss in a later video.

At least 50% of your applications should be warm.

Let that sink in — if you submit 100 applications, 50+ need to be warm.

Warm applications are how you get results in this market.

If all you do is cold apply, shame on you. You should feel bad about yourself. You're digging your own grave. This is the day that your life changes forever.

Identify the level you're on + set your focus.

We discussed your Zone of Focus in the earlier module. This is the area of the Stairway to Software Heaven.

Find the step you're on — and your Zone of Focus is the next two levels.

How Many Applications To Submit?

At least 8-10/week and at least half need to be warm. At the end of the year, you should have submitted at least 300-400 applications and 100-150 warm.

How To Find Companies To Apply To: Warm Leads

Phase 1: A warm lead is defined as a company where you already have someone in your network that works there.

*HW: Fill out this “**Warm Leads & Cold Leads**” worksheet. This should take around 45 minutes.*

Come back to this part AFTER you have filled out **Part 1** of the worksheet.

Now that you have listed all of the connections and companies you know, you are one step ahead of the rest.

These are the companies you’re going to start with. Why? Because you have warm leads. You now should have a list of 50-100 people at companies that might have software engineering positions.

Order of Operations

Bold + highlight — give yourself 2-4 days to get a referral (warm lead referrals are fast) + apply ASAP.

Bold — get a referral ASAP.

Not bold or highlight — send those contacts this message:

“Hey [name], I hope you’re doing well! I’m reaching out because I’m looking for a software engineering internship/new software engineering job, and I was wondering if [insert their company name] offered any software or IT internship/job roles. Please let me know, thank you so much!”

If they say yes, then Bold and get a referral from them ASAP.

Do this after you finish the next video, however. Just keep them on this worksheet for now.



Cold Leads

We started with warm leads because you already had a contact at those companies, which makes getting a referral **5x easier**. While we start with warm leads, that's definitely not enough — we're going to branch out and I'm going to show you how you can submit warm applications, as in get a referral or make a contact, at basically any company without having a pre-existing network. The strategy changes based on what you're aiming for — there are effectively two levels.

Here's a list of **50 mid-size cities** that most likely have internships/jobs that are less competitive.

- | | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Austin, TX | 18. Indianapolis, IN | 35. Syracuse, NY |
| 2. Raleigh, NC | 19. St. Louis, MO | 36. Grand Rapids, MI |
| 3. Salt Lake City, UT | 20. Louisville, KY | 37. Ann Arbor, MI |
| 4. Denver, CO | 21. Birmingham, AL | 38. Milwaukee, WI |
| 5. Boulder, CO | 22. Chattanooga, TN | 39. Cleveland, OH |
| 6. Portland, OR | 23. Albuquerque, NM | 40. Cincinnati, OH |
| 7. Nashville, TN | 24. Tucson, AZ | 41. Tampa, FL |
| 8. Charlotte, NC | 25. Oklahoma City, OK | 42. Orlando, FL |
| 9. Pittsburgh, PA | 26. Tulsa, OK | 43. Jacksonville, FL |
| 10. Madison, WI | 27. Little Rock, AR | 44. Baton Rouge, LA |
| 11. Columbus, OH | 28. Greenville, SC | 45. New Orleans, LA |
| 12. Kansas City, MO | 29. Charleston, SC | 46. Shreveport, LA |
| 13. Boise, ID | 30. Durham, NC | 47. Jackson, MS |
| 14. Omaha, NE | 31. Wilmington, DE | 48. Columbia, SC |
| 15. Richmond, VA | 32. Hartford, CT | 49. Boise, ID |
| 16. Des Moines, IA | 33. Albany, NY | 50. Fargo, ND |
| 17. Provo, UT | 34. Rochester, NY | |



Location Hacking

First, you're going to list out 5 locations on Part 2: Cold Leads of the worksheet— cities or towns. You start with where you're currently located, so #1 is going to be the medium-sized city or town closest to you.

Where do the majority of people work?

So if I lived in Dubuque, Iowa, I'd probably write down Madison, WI, because it's about an hour away and it's a semi large town/city.

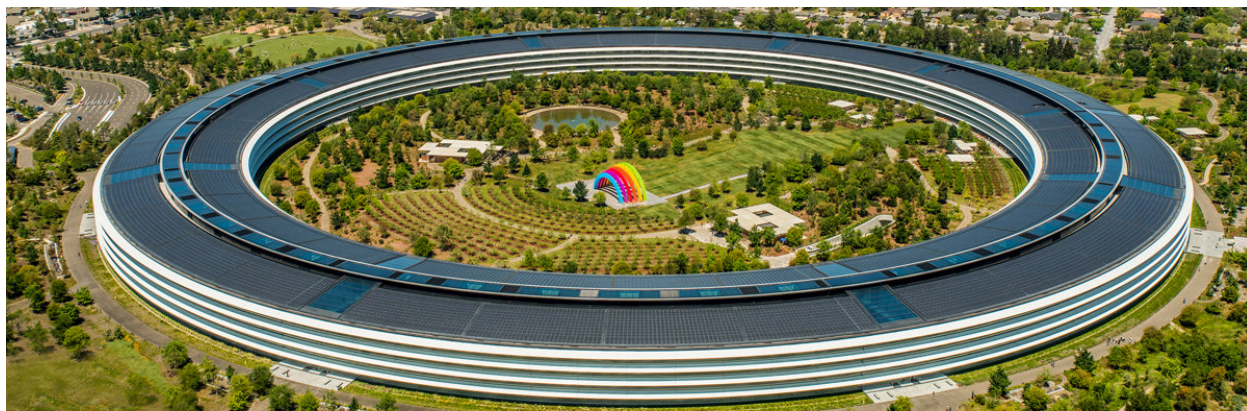
If you're in a big city like Los Angeles or New York City, that's fine, still write that city down as #1. But you're going to add a new line like this and input three parts of the big city — so since I'm in LA right now, I could write down Downtown LA, Hollywood, and Culver City.

Then, you're going to go down this list and write out 4 other cities/towns that are within an expanding radius of you. You should open up Google Maps to help out with this.

So if I was in Davenport, IA, where I grew up, I'd start with Moline as the first option but then I'd branch out like this. Des Moines, Cedar Rapids, Chicago, Peoria.

Keep it relatively small-ish — I know that I listed Chicago as one option, but ideally, you focus on smaller towns rather than larger ones.

Same thing if you're in a big city — so if I was in San Francisco, I'd look at the map and list — San Jose, Santa Clara, Palo Alto, Sacramento, Sunnyvale, etc, or if I was in LA, I might list San Diego, Irvine, etc.



Google Manhunt

You're going to go down the list and continue to fill out **Part 2** of the worksheet with company names. Input each city, and you're going to fill out 10 company names that you'll find like this.

Google: city, software engineering job, internship, etc. Once you find one that looks good, you're going to note that down. Aim for 10 per city. Double check the listing is still active

That's how you get your initial list of jobs to apply to if you're at the small company stage of the process. The key here is to not include large brand name companies. We don't want to write any FAANG or Unicorn options here, not yet.

Also, you're not actually applying to these just yet. This is just so you build out your initial list of companies before you get warm leads so you can warm apply rather than cold.

Bold/highlight roles that are currently open, but still list closed ones.

Career Fairs & Connections

- Look at your University career fair & add all those companies to your list (bold / highlight)
- Look at other University career fairs
 - If it's private, then maybe find someone you know from that school & ask them.
- Go on LinkedIn, find people who are CS @ your university, and see where they did their first internship / job.
 - Check 20-30 people.
 - Add those companies to your list.



FAANG / Name-Brand

Now, if your goal is to make it to a FAANG / name-brand company — double check the stairway to software heaven — this is what you're going to do.

[GitHub List.](#)

What is it?

Link internship + new grad role

Our goal is to generate a list of 50-100 roles from this list, now the key here is to search by location. Start with that, and then list everything on this list that fits into your next step.

Don't add Quant if you're not there, keep it within your grasp. You should also still do this if you're going for small companies, just make sure to not look at things that are out of your reach ie FAANG / Quant.

If the position is open, bold/highlight that company name.

Pause the video and finish both the worksheets before you move on.

You should now have a list of 100+ companies on your radar. Please submit that in the form below.

Next steps are such:

Start with the bold/highlighted, open roles. Start with warm leads, give yourself 3 days to get a referral before applying. For the bold/highlighted cold leads, give yourself 4-5 days to get a referral before applying.

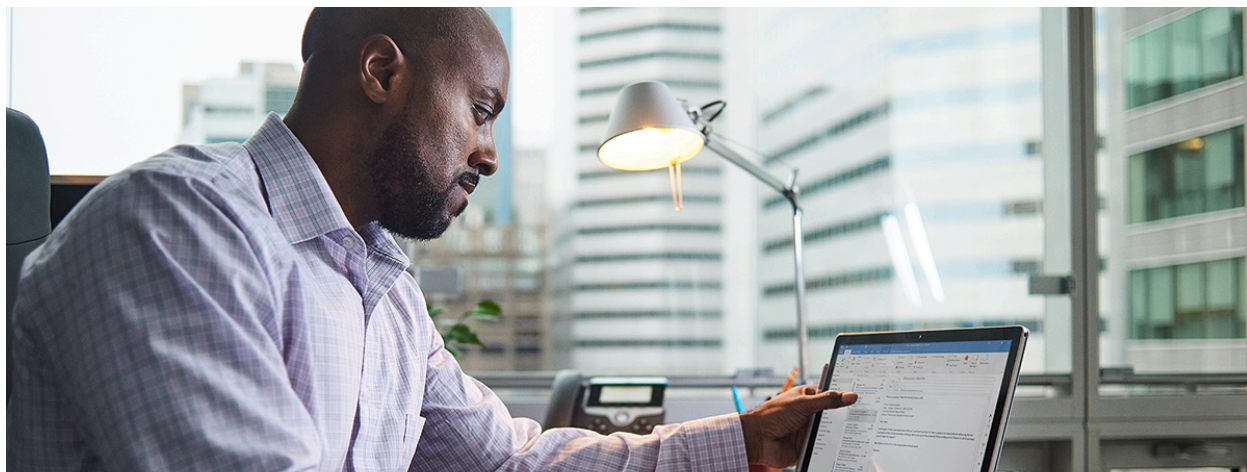
Caveat — if there is a deadline on the application, then do your best to get a referral but if you can't then just apply.

Then go to bold (get a referral for those), and then non bold, and get a referral for those too.

We'll discuss how to get a referral in the next module, but just so you have this on your mind.



You MUST finish all the bold/highlighted options within 1 week, max. Your application has to be in those, because you have a timer. Obviously, you need to go for a warm application which I'll explain how to do later, but even if you can't get one, still submit your application.



Next steps

You'll want to come back to this worksheet after you exhaust all companies on this list (apply to every single open role + get a referral to every job) and do it again for new locations.

Pick 5 new locations or areas you have friends or family at, and then fill it out again.

Do this until you get a job.

If you can't fill out 50 companies through this process for the 5 locations you picked, which you should, then pick some new locations.

If you get rejected, strike the position through.

If you get interviewed, **you can highlight it in a different color.** Use this worksheet to keep track of your applications.

Usually I don't advocate for the necessity of tracking your applications, but it can be helpful for following up on your application (which I will discuss in the next video).

Cadence

You now know how to find roles to apply to. In terms of cadence, you're going to find **at least 10 new companies in your zone** of focus per week and then follow all the systems to apply (with a referral).

Submit 40-60 applications per month, and make them as warm as possible (at least 20+ warm).

Add them to this list. Once you apply or get rejected, strike them off.

The Fortune is in The Follow-Up

I know someone who got an Apple internship because they met a recruiter at a career fair, got the recruiter information, and followed up 7 times before he got the first interview.

He got that internship, turned it into a return offer, and is starting in the summer.

You **MUST** follow up on EVERY job application you submit. Every one.

Reference follow up script in Psychic Job Hunting

System

Show how this all fits together.

Find 10 new companies using the systems, bold/highlight the ones with open roles

Start with those, get a warm lead based on the referral systems

Once you get a referral, apply. Then follow up every 14 days on the application.

If the timer expires, apply, then get referral and follow up + every 14 days.